

Preparatory Cycle  
First Year

Academic Year : 2024/2025  
Course : Algebra 1

## Worksheet 1 : Mathematical logic and mathematical reasoning

The starred exercises are to be done in tutorial sessions

### Exercise 1. \*

1. Give two statements  $P$  and  $Q$  such that
  - (a)  $P \implies Q$  is true and  $Q \implies P$  is true.
  - (b)  $P \implies Q$  is true and  $Q \implies P$  is false.
  - (c)  $P \implies Q$  is false and  $Q \implies P$  true.
2. Is it possible to find two statements  $P$  and  $Q$  such that  $P \implies Q$  is false and  $Q \implies P$  is false ?

### Exercise 2. \*

Let  $P$ ,  $Q$ , and  $R$  be three statements.

1. Show that the following compound statements are logically equivalent by using two different methods.
  - (a)  $P \implies (Q \vee R)$  and  $(P \wedge \overline{R}) \implies Q$ .
  - (b)  $\overline{(P \vee \overline{Q})} \vee (\overline{P} \wedge \overline{Q})$  and  $\overline{P}$ .
  - (c)  $(P \wedge (\overline{\overline{P} \vee Q})) \vee (P \wedge Q)$  and  $P$ .
  - (d)  $((P \implies Q) \wedge (Q \implies R)) \implies (P \implies R)$ .
2. Without using the truth table, simplify the statement  $(\overline{P} \wedge Q) \vee (\overline{P} \wedge \overline{Q}) \vee (P \wedge Q)$ .
3. Verify whether the following compound statements are tautologies, contradictions, or contingencies.
  - (a)  $(P \wedge Q) \wedge \overline{(P \vee Q)}$ .
  - (b)  $(P \vee Q) \wedge \overline{P} \implies Q$ .
  - (c)  $(P \implies Q) \iff (\overline{P} \implies Q)$ .
  - (d)  $((P \implies Q) \wedge (Q \implies R)) \implies (P \implies R)$ .

### Exercise 3.

Give the logical relationships between the following statements.

1.  $P_1$  : All men are mortal.
2.  $P_2$  : All men are immortal.
3.  $P_3$  : No man is mortal.
4.  $P_4$  : No man is immortal.
5.  $P_5$  : There are immortal men.
6.  $P_6$  : There are mortal men.

### Exercise 4. \*

1. Let  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be a map. Using the syntax of the predicates write the following sentences and then give their negation.

- (a)  $f$  is positive.
- (b)  $f$  is the zero function.
- (c)  $f$  is even.
- (d)  $f$  is odd.
- (e)  $f$  is decreasing.
- (f)  $f$  is strictly monotonic.
- (g)  $f$  changes the sign.
- (h)  $f$  is upper bounded.
- (i)  $f$  is constant.
- (j)  $f$  is the identity map.
- (k)  $f$  is periodic.
- (l)  $f$  is strictly increasing.
- (m)  $f$  possesses a maximum.
- (n)  $f$  does not vanish on  $\mathbb{R}$ .
- (o)  $f$  is not constant.
- (p)  $f$  never has the same values at two different points.

2. Using the syntax of the predicates write the following sentences and then give their negation.

- (a) The square of any real number is positive or zero.
- (b) Any positive integer is the sum of three squares.
- (c) For any real number, we can find a real number such that their product is greater than 1.
- (d) Any nonempty part of  $\mathbb{N}$  admits a smallest element.

### Exercise 5. \*

Say if the following statements are true or false and write their negation.

- 1.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, x < 3 \implies x^2 < 9$ .
- 2.  $\forall x, y \in \mathbb{R}, x < y \iff x^2 < y^2$ .
- 3.  $\exists a \in \mathbb{R}, \forall \varepsilon > 0, |a| < \varepsilon$ .
- 4.  $\forall a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, a + ab + b = 0 \iff a = b = 0$ .
- 5.  $\exists x \in \mathbb{R}, (x^3 + 3 = 0 \wedge x + 3 = 0)$ .
- 6.  $(\exists x \in \mathbb{R}, x^3 + 3 = 0) \wedge (\exists x \in \mathbb{R}, x + 3 = 0)$ .
- 7.  $\forall x, y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists n \in \mathbb{N}, nx > y$ .
- 8.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}_+^*, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists n \in \mathbb{N}, nx > y$ .
- 9.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \exists m \in \mathbb{Z}, m \leq x < m + 1$ .
- 10.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}_+^*, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists n \in \mathbb{Z}, 0 \leq y - nx < x$ .
- 11.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}_+^*, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}, \exists m \in \mathbb{Z} : m + 1 \leq y - mx < m$ .
- 12.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{Z}, \exists y \in \mathbb{Z}, \forall z \in \mathbb{Z}, z = x - y$ .
- 13.  $\exists x \in \mathbb{Z}, \forall y \in \mathbb{Z}, \forall z \in \mathbb{Z}, z = x - y$ .
- 14.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}, x^2 + y^2 \in \mathbb{R}_+$ .
- 15.  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \exists y \in \mathbb{R}, x^2 - y^2 \in \mathbb{R}_+$ .
- 16.  $\exists x \in \mathbb{R}, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}, x^2 - y^2 \in \mathbb{R}_+$ .
- 17.  $\forall A \subset E, \exists B \subset E, A \cup B = E$ .
- 18.  $\exists A \subset E, \forall B \subset E, A \cup B = E$ .

### Exercise 6. \*

1. Prove that

- (a)  $\sum_{k=1}^n k^2 = \frac{n(n+1)(2n+1)}{6}$ .
- (b)  $\sum_{k=1}^n k^3 = \frac{n^2(n+1)^2}{4}$ .
- (c)  $\sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{k(k+1)} = \frac{n}{n+1}$ .
- (d)  $\sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{\sqrt{k}} < 2\sqrt{n}$ .
- (e)  $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, 2^{n-1} \leq n! \leq n^n$ .
- (f)  $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, a^n - b^n = (a - b) \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} a^k b^{n-1-k}$ , where  $a, b \in \mathbb{C}$ .

2. Prove each of the following statements using induction.

- (a) If  $x > -1$  is any real number, then  $(1+x)^n \geq 1+nx$  for all  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ .
- (b) The number of parts with  $k$  elements of a set with  $n$  elements is equal to  $\frac{n!}{k!(n-k)!}$ .

(c) For any  $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n \in [0, 1] : \prod_{i=1}^{i=n} (1 - x_i) \geq 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{i=n} x_i$ .

(d) Any integer  $n > 2$  is either prime or has a prime divisor  $p$  such that  $p$  is less or equal to  $\sqrt{n}$ .

3. Using induction show that

(a)  $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \exists (p, q) \in \mathbb{N}_0^2, n = 2^p(2q + 1)$ .

(b)  $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}_0, 10 | (n^5 - n)$ .

(c) Every positive integer can be written as a product of prime factors, and this product is unique up to reordering of the factors.

### Exercise 7.

For any integer  $n \geq 2$ , let  $H_n := \sum_{k=1}^n \frac{1}{k}$ .  $H_n$  is called the  $n$ -th harmonic number. The goal of this exercise is to show that  $H_n$  is not an integer for  $n \geq 2$ .

1. Show that for any positive integer  $m$ , there exist a positive integer  $a$  and nonnegative integer  $b$  such that  $H_{2m} = \frac{1}{2}H_m + \frac{a}{2b+1}$ .
2. Using induction, show that for any integer  $n \geq 2$ ,  $H_n$  is a quotient of an odd integer and an even integer.
3. Deduce that  $H_n$  is not an integer for  $n \geq 2$ .

### Exercise 8. \*

1. Using the proof by contrapositive, show that the following statements are true.
  - (a) For  $n \in \mathbb{N}$ , if  $3n^2 + n + 2$  is odd then  $n$  is odd.
  - (b) If  $a^2$  is not an integer multiple of 16, then  $a/2$  is not an even integer.
  - (c) For two positive integers  $a$  and  $n$ , if  $a^n - 1$  is a prime number, then  $a = 2$  and  $n$  is a prime number.
  - (d)  $\forall x \in \mathbb{R}, \forall y \in \mathbb{R}$ , if  $xy \neq 1$  and  $x \neq y$ , then  $\frac{x}{x^2 + x + 1} \neq \frac{y}{y^2 + y + 1}$ .
2. Using the proof by contradiction, show that the following statements are true.
  - (a)  $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, \sqrt{n^2 + 1} \notin \mathbb{N}$ .
  - (b) If  $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ , then  $a^2 - 4b - 2 \neq 0$ .
  - (c) If  $a, b, c \in \mathbb{Z}$  such that  $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$ , then  $a$  or  $b$  is even.
  - (d)  $\sqrt{p} \notin \mathbb{Q}$ , for any prime number  $p$ .
  - (e)  $\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3} \notin \mathbb{Q}$ .
  - (f)  $\frac{\ln 2}{\ln 3} \notin \mathbb{Q}$ .
  - (g)  $\cos(\frac{\pi}{180}) \notin \mathbb{Q}$ .
  - (h) Let  $p_1, p_2, \dots, p_r$  be prime numbers. The integer  $N = p_1 p_2 \dots p_r + 1$  is not divisible by any of the integers  $p_i, 1 \leq i \leq r$ .

### Exercise 9.

Find two irrational numbers  $a, b$  such that  $a^b$  is a rational number.

### Exercise 10. \*

1. Find all maps  $f : \mathbb{N}_0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{N}_0$  that satisfy,  $f(n + m) = f(n) + f(m)$  for all nonnegative integers  $n$  and  $m$ .
2. Find all maps  $g : \mathbb{N}_0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{N}_0$  that satisfy,  $g(n + m) = g(n) \times g(m)$  for all nonnegative integers  $n$  and  $m$ .
3. Find all functions  $h : \mathbb{R} \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}$  that satisfy, for all  $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$ ,  $h(y - h(x)) = 2 - x - y$ .